📚 Daily Editorial Vocabulary — Master List

1476 words in 453 meaning-families 18 new today. Near-synonyms share ONE row — the whole family, one meaning, one example, with the interchangeable words in (brackets) at the swap point.

How to use: read the example aloud swapping in each word of the family, then cover the meaning and recall it.

🆕 **Added today:** Accessibility, Catastrophic, Containment, Democratic, Deterrence, Devastation, Disagreements, Fashionable, Instruction, Insubstantial, Investigators, Miscalculated, Perilously, Plastination, Sensibilities, Subordinate, Thunderstorms, Unemployment

🧭 Contents

#	Group	Families	Words
1	📉 Decline, Fall & Weaken	17	76
2	📈 Increase, Rise & Spread	23	43
3	💢 Criticism & Condemnation	9	57
4	👏 Praise, Support & Strengthen	23	69
5	🚧 Block, Hinder & Suppress	12	64
6	⚔️ Conflict, Crisis & Disorder	11	47

#	Group	Families	Words
7	💥 Harm, Damage & Worsen	3	12
8	🔥 Severity, Seriousness & Urgency	22	48
9	❓ Difference, Disagreement & Doubt	11	50
10	🌱 Beginnings, Change & Turning Points	10	38
11	💰 Wealth, Money & Economy	17	65
12	🎯 Skill, Care & Wisdom	10	34
13	🗣️ Speech, Persuasion & Claims	18	61
14	⚡ Strong Feeling, Energy & Zeal	10	31
15	🔍 Examination, Judgement & Standards	3	17
16	🤝 Agreement, Unity & Cooperation	7	47
17	⭐ Certainty, Importance & Authority	12	49
18	🌫️ Hidden, Unclear & Secret	10	26
19	🧱 Real, Concrete & Practical	2	3

#	Group	Families	Words
20	✊ Reject, Revenge & Force	3	21
21	⏳ Time, Lateness & Approach	10	33
22	🎭 Lies, Trickery & Deception	6	17
23	🚧 Problems, Obstacles & Setbacks	7	18
24	🧠 Thinking, Reasoning & Memory	4	28
25	⚖️ Fairness, Honesty & Truth	13	26
26	🌀 Hostility, Bitterness & Stubbornness	7	14
27	👑 Power, Control & Influence	3	9
28	😀 Hope, Calm & Positivity	7	13
29	🎱 Bad, Harmful & Unpleasant	9	42
30	📦 Amount, Size & Plenty	18	34
31	↔️ Difference, Comparison & Opposite	3	4
32	🤲 Catch, Hold & Seize	2	7
33	📌 Cause, Effect & Consequence	7	33

#	Group	Families	Words
34	🔺 Highest & Lowest Points	2	4
35	🗨️ Talkative, Loud & Wordy	2	6
36	🫡 Boldness, Recklessness & Daring	2	4
37	😨 Shyness, Caution & Restraint	4	8
38	▯ Unity, Sameness & Division	3	5
39	🌟 Quality, Character & Behaviour	25	62
40	Other & Mixed	71	74
41	🧬 Word Roots, Prefixes & Latin Phrases	8	74
42	🏛️ Polity, Government & Civics	4	55
43	🔧 Science, Work & Industry	3	48

📉 Decline, Fall & Weaken ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Abate, Ebb, Recede, Wane, Dwindle, Diminish	verb	to gradually become less, smaller or weaker	*As the crisis passed, public anger began to (abate / ebb / recede / wane / dwindle / diminish).*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Allay, Alleviate, Mitigate, Ease, Dampen	verb	to make a fear, pain or problem less severe	*The package was meant to (allay / alleviate / mitigate / ease / dampen) public anxiety.*
Contraction, Deflation, Depreciation, Depression, Stagnation	noun	an economic shrinking, fall or standstill	*Contraction = output shrinking; deflation = a general fall in prices; depreciation = a fall in the value of a currency or asset; depression = a very deep, long collapse; stagnation = a long period with no growth at all.*
Curb, Curtail, Whittle, Attenuate	verb	to deliberately cut back, limit or reduce something	*New rules were framed to (curb / curtail / attenuate) wasteful spending; the panel will whittle the list down to five names.*
Decline	verb	sense 1: to go down or decrease	*Enrolment has declined for the third year running.*
Decline	verb	sense 2: to politely refuse	*The minister declined to comment on the report.*
Detachment	noun	being emotionally distant; also a small group of troops sent on a separate task	*He described the tragedy with clinical detachment; a detachment of soldiers was sent to the border.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Deteriorate, Languish, Wither, Unravel	verb	to get steadily worse or fall apart	*Without funding the scheme began to (deteriorate / wither / unravel); thousands languish in overcrowded jails.*
Deteriorating, Stagnant, Downturn, Recession, Plateau, Diminishing returns, Devaluation, Deindustrialisation	noun/adjective	getting worse, shrinking or losing momentum, especially in an economy.	*Output is (deteriorating / stagnant); the (downturn / recession) deepened, growth hit a plateau, and diminishing returns set in after the devaluation and deindustrialisation.*
Erode, Undermine, Subvert, Cripple, Debilitate, Enervate	verb	to weaken or damage something, often gradually or secretly	*Corruption has (eroded / undermined / subverted / crippled / debilitated / enervated) public trust in the institution. Note: subvert = weaken secretly to overthrow; cripple = damage severely.*
Feeble, Fragile, Tenuous, Vulnerable	adjective	weak, easily broken or easily harmed	*The ceasefire rests on a (feeble / fragile / tenuous) understanding; poor households are the most vulnerable to price shocks.*
Flounder, Underprepared, Underestimate, Lopsided, Inequality, Inexperience,	noun/adjective/verb	falling short, being unfairly small, or failing to cope.	*The team (floundered / was underprepared); we (underestimate / undervalue) the gap; the lopsided deal*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Maladroit, Unpopularity, Unfriendliest, Nominal, Disability			*deepened inequality, and his inexperience, maladroit handling and the resulting unpopularity made him the unfriendliest figure in the room, with only nominal support.*
Lethargy, Lassitude, Inertia, Malaise	noun	a state of tiredness, sluggishness or unwillingness to act	*A deep (lethargy / lassitude / inertia / malaise) has settled over the bureaucracy. Note: inertia = resistance to change; malaise = a vague sense that something is unwell.*
Mar, Dent, Flaw	noun/verb	a fault that spoils something, or to spoil it	*The riots (marred / dented) the state's image; a single flaw in the design brought the bridge down.*
Moribund, Inert, Languid, Lethargic, Tepid, Halfhearted, Perfunctory	adjective	lacking energy, effort or life	*The response was (inert / languid / lethargic / tepid / halfhearted / perfunctory); the once-great mill is now moribund. Note: moribund = about to die out completely.*
Plummet, Plunge, Slump, Lag	verb	to fall fast, steeply or behind	*Exports (plummeted / plunged / slumped) after the ban; India continues to lag behind its neighbours on this index.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Resignation, Abdication	noun	formally stepping down from a position or right.	*His (resignation / abdication) ended the crisis.*

📈 Increase, Rise & Spread ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Accelerate, Facilitate, Facilitation, Encroach, Encroachment, Inundate, Contagious, Pandemic	verb/noun	to grow, speed up, spread out or push into new ground.	*Reforms (accelerated / facilitated) growth; the (encroachment / spread) was rapid, cheap credit inundated the market, and the contagious optimism went pandemic.*
circum	root	root CIRCUM = around	*circumference, circumnavigate, circumspect.*
cred	root	root CRED = believe	*credit, credible, incredible, credentials.*
dict	root	root DICT = say, speak	*dictate, predict, contradict, verdict.*
Disseminate, Diffuse	verb	to spread something widely; *diffuse* also = to calm a tense situation	*The app (disseminated / diffused) weather alerts to millions; talks helped diffuse the tension.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Escalate, Soar, Surge, Proliferate, Wax	verb	to rise, grow or spread quickly; *wax* = to increase gradually	*Prices (escalated / soared / surged) after the ban; misinformation proliferated online while the party's influence waxed.*
Exodus	noun	a large number of people leaving a place	*The lockdown triggered an exodus of migrant workers.*
Germinate, Germinal	verb/adjective	to begin to grow or develop, like a seed or an idea; *germinal* = at the earliest stage	*The idea germinated in a college seminar; the paper is the germinal work in the field.*
Hike	verb	to raise a price or rate	*The bank hiked interest rates again.*
Increasingly	adverb	more and more over time	*Cities are increasingly reliant on tanker water.*
Inflation	noun	the general rise in prices over time	*Food inflation stayed above eight per cent.*
magn	root	root MAGN = great, large	*magnify, magnificent, magnitude, magnate.*
Magnitude, Measure	noun/verb	the size or scale of something; to find out that size	*No one grasped the magnitude of the loss; the study measured its true cost.*
mal	root	root MAL = bad	*malice, malevolent, malfunction, malign.*
Marginalise	verb	to push a group to the edges of society and ignore their needs	*The policy further marginalised landless labourers.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Overwhelming	verb	engulf, surge over and submerge	*India's 'cockroach' protest continues a day after police crackdown Delhi witnessed overwhelming violence on Monday, with at least 60 protesters wounded.*
Prevalence	noun	how common or widespread something is	*The survey measured the prevalence of anaemia among children.*
Rampant, Rife, Ubiquitous	adjective	very common and spreading everywhere, usually of something bad; *ubiquitous* = present everywhere	*Corruption was (rampant / rife) in the department; smartphones are now ubiquitous.*
re-	prefix	prefix RE- = again, back	*rewrite, return, rebuild, revise.*
super-/sur-	prefix	prefix SUPER-/SUR- = above, over	*superman, supervise, surplus, surface.*
Surge, Hike, Expansion, Ascendancy	noun	a sudden or sustained increase in level, price or power	*A (surge / hike) in fuel rates followed; the decade saw rapid expansion and the ascendancy of a new elite.*
Sustainable, Holistic	adjective	able to continue long-term; taking the whole into account rather than parts	*The plan is neither (sustainable / holistic) nor affordable.*
Yield	verb	to produce or give a result or amount	*The new seed yields twice as much per hectare.*

Criticism & Condemnation ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Admonish, Berate, Lambast, Lambaste, Harangue, Slam, Censure, Condemn, Deplore	verb	to scold, attack or officially blame someone strongly; *censure* is the most formal, *admonish* the mildest	*The court (admonished / berated / lambasted / lambaste / slammed / censured / condemned / deplored) the delay; he (harangued) the crowd for an hour.*
Castigate, Excoriate, Deride, Disparage, Vituperate	verb	to attack someone with harsh words. Castigate, excoriate and vituperate are severe; deride and disparage are mocking or belittling.	*The court (castigated / excoriated / derided / disparaged / vituperated) the officials for the delay.*
Culpable, Accountability, Onus, Obligation, Absolve, Exonerate, Vindicate	adjective	to do with being blamed or cleared of blame; *culpable* = at fault, *absolve / exonerate / vindicate* are verbs = to clear someone	*Officials were found (culpable) and (accountability) followed; the (onus) and (obligation) lay with the ministry, but the inquiry later (absolved / exonerated / vindicated) the staff.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Denigrate, Vilify, Malign, Calumny, Invective, Obloquy, Opprobrium, Tirade	noun	abusive speech, or the public disgrace it brings; *denigrate / vilify / malign* are verbs = to run down unfairly, *calumny* = a false damaging statement, *obloquy / opprobrium* = harsh public shaming	*The campaign was pure (calumny / invective / obloquy / opprobrium), a (tirade) meant to (denigrate / vilify / malign) a rival.*
Ignominy, Humiliation, Affront, Accusation, Allegation, Defamation	noun	public disgrace, or an act or charge that wounds pride and reputation.	*He suffered the (ignominy / humiliation / affront) of public dismissal; an (accusation / allegation) followed, and he sued for defamation.*
Impudent, Brazen, Boorish, Surly, Petulant, Obtuse, Voluble	adjective	rude, ill-mannered or unpleasant in manner; *voluble* = talking non-stop, *obtuse* = slow to understand	*His (impudent / brazen / boorish / surly / petulant) reply showed him to be (obtuse); a (voluble) speaker filled the rest of the hour.*
Lament, Bemoan, Contrite, Penitent	verb	to express sorrow or regret; *contrite / penitent* are adjectives = feeling deep remorse for a wrong	*Leaders (lament / bemoan) the loss; the (contrite / penitent) official offered to resign.*
Notorious, Reprehensible, Egregious, Flagrant, Glaring, Heinous, Iniquity	adjective	openly and shockingly bad, deserving blame; *iniquity* is a noun = great wickedness or injustice	*A (notorious / reprehensible / egregious / flagrant / glaring / heinous) breach of duty exposed the (iniquity) of the system.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Scathing, Vitriolic, Acrimonious, Indictment	adjective	bitterly harsh in criticism; *indictment* is a noun = a formal charge or a damning verdict on something	*The (scathing / vitriolic) report followed an (acrimonious) debate and reads as an (indictment) of the whole scheme.*

👏 Praise, Support & Strengthen ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Abet	verb	to help someone do something wrong	*Officials were accused of aiding and abetting illegal sand mining.*
Acclaim, Approbation	noun	strong public praise and approval	*The reform won wide (acclaim / approbation) from economists.*
Advocate, Stalwart	noun	a loyal, reliable supporter of a cause	*She has been a lifelong (advocate / stalwart) of press freedom.*
Backbone, Keystone, Collateral	noun	the main supporting part on which something rests; *collateral* = the asset pledged to back a loan	*Small farms are the (backbone / keystone) of the rural economy; the loan required land as collateral.*
Bolster, Boost, Underpin, Augment, Foster, Embolden	verb	to support, strengthen or encourage the growth of something; *underpin* = form the base of;	*The subsidy (bolstered / boosted / augmented / fostered) rural demand; strong institutions underpin democracy; the win*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		embolden = give courage	*emboldened the protesters.*
Boost, Impetus, Stimulus, Incentive	noun	something that pushes an activity forward or encourages action	*The tax cut gave a much-needed (boost / impetus / stimulus / incentive) to manufacturing.*
Corroborate, Substantiate, Verify	verb	to prove or back up a claim with evidence	*Independent data (corroborated / substantiated / verified) the whistleblower's account.*
Egalitarian, Meritocracy	adjective/noun	based on equal treatment or on rising by talent rather than birth	*He pushed an egalitarian tax policy; the exam system is meant to be a meritocracy.*
Endeavour	noun	a serious effort to achieve something	*The mission was a bold scientific endeavour.*
Endorse, Espouse, Advocate, Ratify	verb	to publicly support, approve or adopt a cause or agreement; *ratify* = formal approval of a treaty	*The party (endorsed / espoused / advocated) the new labour code; Parliament finally ratified the treaty.*
Enfranchise	verb	to give someone the right to vote or full citizenship rights	*The amendment enfranchised millions of young voters.*
Laud, Hail, Eulogise, Acclaim	verb	to praise someone or something publicly	*Critics (lauded / hailed / eulogised / acclaimed) the new welfare scheme.*
Laudable, Warranted	adjective	deserving praise, or justified by the facts	*The effort was (laudable / warranted)*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			given the scale of the crisis.
Magnanimous, Magnanimity, Munificent, Munificence, Benevolent, Benign, Altruistic, Lavish	adjective/noun	kind, well-meaning and generous in giving. Magnanimity and munificence are the noun forms; altruistic = selflessly caring for others; benign = gentle and harmless; lavish = giving very freely.	*A (magnanimous / munificent / benevolent / altruistic / lavish) donor funded the school; her (magnanimity / munificence) was widely praised, and the gesture was entirely benign.*
Pledge, Vow, Covenant	verb/noun	a serious, formal promise; to promise firmly	*The government (pledged / vowed) to double spending on health; the two states signed a covenant on water sharing.*
Recoup	verb	to get back money or losses	*Airlines struggled to recoup pandemic losses.*
Resilience	noun	the ability to recover quickly after a shock or disaster	*The community showed remarkable resilience after the floods.*
Restoration	noun	the process of bringing something back to its original state	*The restoration of the old fort took five years.*
Staunch, Steadfast, Stalwart, Resilient	adjective	firmly loyal, unwavering and able to withstand difficulty	*He remained a (staunch / steadfast / stalwart) defender of the constitution; the economy proved resilient.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Strengthening, Emulate, Therapeutic, Salubrious, Innocuous, Tractable	verb/adjective	to build up, back or make stronger; also to copy someone you admire.	*The reform is (strengthening / emulating) the best global practice; the therapeutic and salubrious effects were clear, and the innocuous change met no resistance.*
Thrive	verb	to grow well and become very successful	*Start-ups thrive where regulation is light.*
Venerate, Reverence, Reverent, Venerable, Pious, Sacrosanct, Inviolable	noun/adjective/verb	deep respect, or showing it. Venerate = to revere deeply (verb); venerable = respected because of age or wisdom; pious = religiously devoted; sacrosanct and inviolable = too sacred or important to be touched or broken.	*Students (venerate / revere) the venerable teacher; he spoke with (reverence / a reverent tone); the pious crowd treated the shrine as (sacrosanct / inviolable).*
Woo, Garner	verb	to win over or gather support, votes or attention	*The party (wooed / garnered) young voters ahead of the polls.*

🚧 Block, Hinder & Suppress ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Avert, Forestall, Preclude, Obviate, Deter	verb	to act in time so that something bad never happens; *deter* = to put someone off by	*Early warning helped (avert / forestall / preclude) a famine; heavy fines (deter)*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		fear of consequences, *obviate* = to remove the need for something	*offenders; a good design (obviates) the need for repairs.*
Blockade, Embargo, Moratorium, Interdict	noun	an official ban, sealing-off or temporary stop on trade, movement or an activity; *interdict* is also used as a verb = to stop officially	*The council imposed a (blockade / embargo / moratorium) on new mining; patrols (interdict) smuggled goods.*
Cumbersome, Intractable, Wayward, Fractious, Relentless	adjective	hard to handle, hard to solve or impossible to stop	*The (cumbersome) rulebook makes an (intractable) problem worse; a (wayward / fractious) coalition faced (relentless) pressure.*
Deplete, Forfeit, Cede, Capitulate, Abandon	verb	to use up, give up or surrender something; *deplete* = to drain a stock, *forfeit* = to lose as a penalty	*Drought (depletes) reserves; the club had to (forfeit) the match; rebels chose to (cede / capitulate) rather than fight on, and (abandon) their posts.*
Docile, Mollycoddle, Complacent, Indolent	adjective	easily controlled, over-protected or too relaxed to act; *mollycoddle* is a verb = to pamper	*A (docile) workforce asks no questions; parents who (mollycoddle) children raise (complacent / indolent) adults.*
Halt, Stall, Stem, Throttle, Quell, Subdue	verb	to stop, hold back or bring under control, sometimes by force; *quell / subdue* = put down resistance	*Troops moved to (halt / stem / quell / subdue) the riot; red tape (stalls / throttles) new projects.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Hamper, Hinder, Impede, Stymie, Thwart, Derail, Disrupt	verb	to block, slow down or spoil something so it cannot go forward	*Bad roads (hamper / hinder / impede / stymie / thwart) relief work; protesters tried to (derail / disrupt) the talks.*
Interregnum, Hiatus, Ceasefire, Cancellation	noun	a pause, gap or break in an ongoing activity or rule	*A three-month (hiatus / interregnum) followed the (cancellation) of the session; both sides agreed to a (ceasefire).*
Obfuscate, Obscure, Opaque, Nebulous, Vague, Ambiguous, Equivocal	adjective	unclear, hazy or hard to see through; *obfuscate* is a verb = to make unclear on purpose, *equivocal* = deliberately vague to avoid commitment	*The reply was (vague / ambiguous / nebulous / equivocal); the accounts stay (opaque / obscure) because officials (obfuscate) the figures.*
Pedestrianised	verb	restrict access to to pedestrians only, disallowing motor vehicles	*In the big pedestrianised square Plaza de Olavide, fans had gathered around screens, some sitting on the ground while children and dogs ran around.*
Repression, Subjugate, Yoke, Authoritarianism, Totalitarianism, Authoritarian, Regime	noun	harsh control that crushes people's freedom; *authoritarian* = a ruler demanding total obedience, *regime* = the ruling government itself	*Under the (regime), (repression) and the (yoke) of censorship grew; (authoritarianism / totalitarianism) leaves no room for dissent; the army moved to (subjugate) the region.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Suppression, Prohibition, Nullify, Ostracise, Sanctioned, Deportation, Extradition, Imprisonment, Protectionism	noun/verb	to stop, forbid, cancel or push something down by force of authority. Note: *sanctioned* is a contronym — it usually means hit with official penalties, but can also mean officially approved; read the context.	*The order brought (suppression / prohibition) of the protest; the ruling nullified the licence, activists were ostracised and sanctioned, and deportation, extradition and imprisonment followed under a wall of protectionism.*

 Conflict, Crisis & Disorder ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Belligerent, Pugnacious, Truculent	adjective	aggressive and eager to fight or argue	*He turned (belligerent / pugnacious / truculent) when questioned.*
Cataclysm, Fiasco, Turbulence, Reel, Brunt, Knell, Nemesis, Pyrrhic	noun/verb	a violent disturbance, a total failure, or the shock that follows one.	*The policy ended in a (cataclysm / fiasco); the turbulence made markets reel, the poor bore the brunt, and it sounded the knell for the party's old nemesis.*
Debacle, Travesty	noun	a humiliating failure or a mockery of the real thing	*The rollout was a debacle; the inquiry was a travesty of justice.*
Diplomacy, Neutrality, Proxy, Compromise	noun	managing conflict without direct war	*Diplomacy = managing relations between states*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			through talks; neutrality = refusing to take sides; a proxy is a group fighting on another's behalf; a compromise is a deal where each side gives something up (compromise can also mean to weaken or expose something).
Factional, Polarise, Polarisation, Schism, Partition, Secession, Cleave	verb/noun/adjective	splitting into rival or separate parts	*Factional fighting (polarised / cleaved) the party; the polarisation deepened into an open schism, echoing the partition of 1947 and later demands for secession.*
Hostilities, Discord, Opposition, Grievance	noun	open fighting, disagreement or complaint	*Hostilities resumed along the border; discord within the party grew as the opposition seized on a long-standing grievance.*
Impasse, Stalemate	noun	a situation where neither side can move forward	*Talks reached an (impasse / stalemate).*
Insurgency, Belligerence, Brinkmanship, Fraught, Precarious, Resistance, Dissent, Dissident, Disobedience, Interference	noun/adjective	hostility, armed opposition, open disagreement, or a dangerously tense situation.	*The (insurgency / belligerence / brinkmanship) put the region on edge; (dissent / disobedience / resistance) spread, dissidents were arrested, and the*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			situation grew (fraught / precarious) amid foreign interference.
Kowtow, Obsequious	verb/adjective	behaving in a weak, servile way to please the powerful	*Officials kowtow to the minister; his obsequious praise embarrassed everyone.*
Schadenfreude	noun	pleasure taken in another person's misfortune	*There was open schadenfreude at the rival firm's collapse.*
Turmoil, Upheaval, Tumultuous, Turbulent	noun/adjective	great disorder, confusion or violent change	*The country passed through (turmoil / upheaval) in a (tumultuous / turbulent) decade.*

💥 Harm, Damage & Worsen ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Aggravate, Exacerbate	verb	to make a bad situation worse	*Fresh curbs only (aggravate / exacerbate) the shortage.*
Annihilate, Demolish, Eradicate, Destruction, Elimination, Discard, Truncate	verb/noun	to get rid of something completely, or cut it down.	*The blast (annihilated / demolished / eradicated) the block; the (destruction / elimination) was total, the debris was discarded, and the report was truncated.*
Hapless, Fortuitous, Random	adjective	governed by chance rather than plan;	*The (hapless) crew survived by a*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		hapless = unlucky and helpless, *fortuitous* = luckily unplanned	*(fortuitous), (random) turn of the tide.*

🔥 Severity, Seriousness & Urgency ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Austerity	noun	strict economic policy with sharply reduced public spending	*Years of austerity hollowed out public services.*
Backlash	noun	a strong, angry public reaction against something	*The order triggered a fierce backlash from farmers.*
Breach	noun	the breaking of a rule, law or promise	*The order was a clear breach of privacy law.*
Coerce, Compel, Goad, Provoke	verb	to force, push or deliberately drive someone into acting; *goad/provoke* = to needle into a reaction	*Officials (coerced / compelled) traders to comply; the remarks (goaded / provoked) the crowd.*
Comeuppance	noun	a punishment or fate that is justly deserved	*The scam's masterminds finally got their comeuppance.*
Compound, Fester, Escalate	verb	to make a bad situation worse or grow more serious over time	*Delays (compounded / escalated) the crisis; the grievance was left to fester.*
Corruption	noun	the act of impairing integrity or moral principle; dishonest use of power	*Corruption in procurement drained the budget.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Daunting, Imminent, Looming	adjective	frighteningly difficult, or about to happen very soon	*The task was daunting, with an (imminent / looming) deadline.*
Dire, Acute, Drastic, Stringent, Onerous, Gruelling	adjective	extremely serious, severe or hard to bear; *stringent* = strict; *onerous/gruelling* = heavy and exhausting	*The report warned of a (dire / acute) water shortage; the government took drastic steps and imposed stringent rules; the onerous, gruelling paperwork deterred applicants.*
Escalation	noun	a rise in the intensity of a conflict or dispute	*Both sides warned against further escalation along the border.*
Famine, Starvation	noun	severe, widespread lack of food causing hunger and death	*Drought pushed the region towards (famine / starvation).*
Fervent, Vehement, Emphatic, Trenchant, Compelling	adjective	expressed with strong, forceful feeling or conviction; *trenchant* = sharp and cutting; *compelling* = very convincing	*She made a (fervent / vehement / emphatic) appeal for calm; his trenchant, compelling critique changed the debate.*
Implore, Urge	verb	to request strongly and earnestly	*Doctors (implored / urged) the public to stay indoors.*
Indict, Allege, Blame	verb	to accuse someone of wrongdoing; *indict* = formally charge	*The agency (indicted / blamed) the contractor and alleged large-scale fraud.*
Jingoism, Populism, Autocracy,	noun	political styles based on aggressive	*The speech slid into jingoism; critics saw*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Clientelism		nationalism, mass appeal, one-man rule, or favour-trading	*populism, clientelism and creeping autocracy in the new order.*
Levity, Frivolous	noun/adjective	lack of seriousness; treating a serious matter lightly	*There is no room for levity in a public health crisis; the court dismissed the frivolous petition.*
Loom	verb	to appear close and threatening; to be about to happen	*A fresh crisis looms over the sector.*
Plea	noun	an urgent and emotional request	*The court heard a plea for immediate relief.*
Sanction	noun/verb	a penalty imposed on a country; or, oppositely, official permission	*The council imposed sanctions on the regime; the ministry sanctioned the new post.*
Significant	adjective	large or important enough to matter, especially in results	*The trial showed a significant drop in infections.*
Systemic	adjective	affecting a whole system, not just one part; built into how things work	*The audit exposed systemic failures in the supply chain.*
Zealot, Hardliner, Demagogue	noun	a person holding extreme, uncompromising views; *demagogue* = a leader who stirs emotion rather than facts	*The party was captured by (zealots / hardliners); the campaign was led by a demagogue.*

❓ Difference, Disagreement & Doubt ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Defy, Flout, Spurn, Repudiate, Disenfranchise	verb	to openly refuse, reject or strip away; *flout* = to break a rule openly, *disenfranchise* = to take away someone's rights	*Traders (defy / flout) the ban and (spurn / repudiate) the deal; the new list (disenfranchises) thousands of voters.*
Demonstrators	noun	One who demonstrates anything, or proves beyond doubt	*On Tuesday night, demonstrators' calls were answered as the Ukrainian president fired the general and offered Mr Fedorov a "prominent" role and promised an overhaul of the army command.*
dis-, mis-	prefix	prefixes meaning 'opposite / away' (dis-) and 'wrong / badly' (mis-)	*(dis-) gives disagree, dishonest, disappear; (mis-) gives misunderstand, misguide, misuse.*
Disappointment, Deficit	noun	a shortfall — of expectation or of money	*The result was a (disappointment); the budget showed a widening (deficit).*
Disparate, Discordant, Contentious, Tussle	adjective	clashing or likely to cause conflict; *tussle* is a noun = a struggle for control	*A (disparate / discordant) alliance took up the (contentious) bill, and a long (tussle) followed.*
Disparity, Discrepancy,	noun	a gap, mismatch or difference between	*The (disparity / discrepancy / gulf /*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Deviation, Inconsistencies, Gulf, Fissure, Lacuna, Margin, Margin of error, Outlier		things that should match; *lacuna* = a missing part in a law or argument, *outlier* = a value far from the rest	*fissure) between the two figures was clear; auditors flagged (deviation), (inconsistencies), a (lacuna) in the rules, a wide (margin) / (margin of error), and one (outlier).*
Misconception, Misnomer, Misinformation, Misrepresented, Misunderstood, Perplex, Anomaly, Aberration	noun/verb/adjective	a wrong idea, or the act of getting something wrong or being wrongly named.	*The claim rests on a (misconception / misnomer / piece of misinformation); the data was (misrepresented / misunderstood), which perplexed readers, and the anomaly proved to be a mere aberration.*
Nuance, Threshold, Benchmark, Yardstick	noun	a fine distinction or a fixed point used for comparison; *nuance* = a small but important shade of meaning	*Every (nuance) matters once a score crosses the (threshold); the scheme became the (benchmark / yardstick) for others.*
Tantamount	adjective	equal to or the same as something (usually something bad)	*Silence here is (tantamount) to consent.*
Uncertainty, Vacillate, Inconclusive	noun	doubt or the inability to settle on an answer; *vacillate* is a verb = to keep changing your mind	*(Uncertainty) grew as the tests stayed (inconclusive) and the board continued to (vacillate).*
Untenable, Purported, Incredulous, Credulous, Cynical, Perfidious, Perfidy,	adjective/noun	not believable, refusing to believe, or breaking trust.	*The defence is (untenable / purported at best); she was incredulous while a credulous public*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Complicit, Ambivalent, Prejudicial			*accepted it; his cynical view proved right when the (perfidious / complicit) aide's perfidy came out.*

 Beginnings, Change & Turning Points ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Amend, Adaptation, Overhaul, Intervention	noun/verb	a change made to fix or improve something	*Parliament may amend the Act; the tax system needs a complete overhaul; adaptation to a warmer climate now requires state intervention.*
Entrench, Hidebound, Persist, Obdurate, Obstinate, Intransigent, Adamant	adjective/verb	refusing to change, or fixed so firmly it cannot be changed	*Caste privilege is deeply entrenched; a hidebound bureaucracy resists reform and old habits persist; the union stayed (obdurate / obstinate / intransigent / adamant) through eight rounds of talks.*
Heterodox	adjective	not following accepted or usual beliefs	*She defended a heterodox view of growth.*
Nascent, Fledgling, Outset	adjective/noun	at the very beginning; new and inexperienced	*The (nascent / fledgling) industry needs protection; the flaw was obvious from the outset.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Opportunities, Possibility, Feasibility, Feasible, Viable	noun/adjective	a chance, or whether something can practically be done	*Reform opened up new opportunities and raised the possibility of growth; a feasibility study found the plan (feasible / viable).*
Procrastinate	verb	to keep putting off what must be done	*The ministry procrastinated for years before acting.*
Tentative	adjective	not final or certain; a first attempt that may change	*The two sides reached a tentative agreement.*
Usher, Kindle, Spark, Prompt, Galvanise, Mobilise, Catalyst	verb/noun	to set something off or stir people into action	*The verdict (sparked / prompted / kindled) protests and (galvanised / mobilised) the opposition; it ushered in a new era and became the catalyst for reform.*
Volatile, Mercurial, Instability, Vicissitude	adjective/noun	changing suddenly and unpredictably	*Oil prices remain (volatile / unstable); his mercurial temper unsettled the cabinet; instability and the vicissitudes of politics stalled the project.*
Watershed, Paradigm, Transition, Trend, Baseline	noun	a turning point, model or direction of change	*1991 was a watershed year that marked a paradigm shift; the transition to renewables is the clear trend, measured against a 2005 baseline.*

💰 Wealth, Money & Economy ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Affluent, Opulent, Lucrative	adjective	rich, or producing wealth	*They live in an (affluent / opulent) neighbourhood; software turned out to be a lucrative business. Note: opulent stresses visible luxury; lucrative = profit-making.*
Arrears, Indebtedness, Creditor, Leverage, Liquidity, Coffer	noun	debt, what is owed, and available money	*Arrears = overdue payments; indebtedness = the burden of owing a lot; a creditor is the one owed; leverage = borrowed money used to chase bigger profits; liquidity = how easily assets turn into spendable cash; the state's coffers are its store of funds.*
Contribution, Contributions, Contributing	noun/verb	something given that becomes part of a larger whole.	*Each member's (contribution / contributions) mattered; every donor contributing to the fund was named.*
Destitute	adjective	extremely poor, lacking even food and shelter	*The floods left thousands destitute.*
Fiscal, Monetary, Neoliberalism, Industrialisation	noun/adjective	terms describing economic policy and economic change	*Fiscal policy covers government spending and taxes, while monetary policy*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			covers money supply and interest rates; neoliberalism favours free markets and trade liberalisation; industrialisation is the shift from a pre-industrial to an industrial economy.
Frugal, Husbandry	adjective/noun	careful, non-wasteful management of money and resources	*A frugal household saves where it can; careful husbandry of water made the district drought-proof.*
Generous	adjective	willing to give freely (opposite: stingy)	*A generous donor funded the entire wing.*
Indigent, Penurious, Penury, Parsimonious, Prodigal, Rapacious, Scarce, Negligible	adjective/noun	extremely poor, or unwilling to spend. Prodigal is the opposite — wastefully extravagant; rapacious = aggressively greedy.	*The (indigent / penurious / parsimonious) household had nothing to spare; penury forced the sale, while his prodigal brother squandered a fortune and a rapacious lender took the rest.*
Largesse, Subsidy, Bailout, Redistribution, Remittance, Reparations, Allocate	noun/verb	money handed out, transferred or set aside	*Allocate = to set money aside for a purpose; subsidy = government money to lower a cost; bailout = emergency rescue money for a failing firm or bank; largesse = generous giving by the powerful;*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			redistribution = sharing wealth more evenly through tax and welfare; remittance = money sent home by workers abroad; reparations = money paid for war damage.
Levy, Default, Commodity, Volatility, Overheating, Insolvent, Sovereign, Macroeconomic, Globalisation, Affordable, Unaffordable, Subscription, Transactional, Misappropriation, Optimization	noun/adjective	terms about money, markets, trade and the wider economy.	*A new (levy / default / commodity) shock triggered volatility; overheating followed, firms turned insolvent, and sovereign debt strained the macroeconomic outlook amid globalisation.*
Livelihood	noun	the way a person earns a living	*The ban destroyed the livelihood of thousands of weavers.*
Magnate, Billionaires, Plutocracy	noun	the very rich, and rule by them	*A steel magnate and two billionaires bankrolled the campaign; critics call the system a plutocracy.*
Ostentatious	adjective	showing off wealth to impress others	*His ostentatious wedding drew sharp criticism.*
Prosperity	noun	the state of being rich and doing well	*Two decades of reform brought*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			unprecedented prosperity.
Recovery, Resurgence	noun	a rise or return to health after a fall	*The data point to a (recovery / resurgence) in rural demand.*
Squander, Fritter, Profligate, Cupidity, Venal, Embezzle	verb/adjective	to waste money, or greed and corruption over money	*The board (squandered / frittered away) a decade of profits; profligate spending emptied the treasury; cupidity and venal officials let one clerk embezzle the pension fund. Note: embezzle = steal money you were trusted with.*
Voracious	adjective	wanting a very large amount; greedy or intensely eager	*The country has a voracious appetite for imported oil.*

🎯 Skill, Care & Wisdom ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Acumen	noun	the ability to think and judge quickly and well	*Her business acumen saved the firm.*
Adept, Adroit, Deft, Nimble	adjective	skilful, clever and quick	*She is (adept / adroit / deft / nimble) at handling hostile questions.*
Assiduous, Erudite, Versatile, Discernment,	adjective/noun	showing careful effort, sound judgement, wide	*She is (assiduous / erudite / versatile) and known for her*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Arduous, Equanimity, Sangfroid		learning or calm control.	*discernment; the arduous negotiation demanded (equanimity / sangfroid).*
Cautious, Wary	adjective	careful about possible danger	*Investors remain (cautious / wary) about the new rules.*
Heuristic, Estimate, Variable, Control, Empirical, Correlate, Correlation, Consistent	noun/verb/adjective	the vocabulary of testing, measuring and reasoning from evidence	*A heuristic is a rough rule of thumb; an estimate is a careful guess; a variable is a factor that changes and is measured; a control group gets no treatment and is used for comparison; empirical claims rest on observation rather than theory; two things correlate when they move together, and that link is a correlation; results are consistent when they hold from test to test.*
Inept	adjective	lacking skill; clumsy and incompetent	*The rescue effort was hopelessly inept.*
Meticulous, Painstaking, Diligent, Systematic, Scrutiny	adjective/noun	careful, thorough and methodical	*The audit was (meticulous / painstaking / systematic) and the team diligent; every claim was put under close scrutiny.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Ontological	adjective	concerning the nature of being and what really exists	*The debate turned on an ontological question about what a nation is.*
Sagacious, Sage, Prudent, Nuanced	adjective	wise and showing good judgement	*It was a (sagacious / sage / prudent) decision; his nuanced reading of the data impressed the panel. Note: nuanced = alive to fine distinctions.*
Systematically	adverb	in an organised, methodical way	*Records were systematically destroyed.*

🗣️ Speech, Persuasion & Claims ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Albeit, Whereby, Insofar, insofar as, Henceforth, Hitherto, Previously, Conceivably, Presumably, Ostensibly, Fundamentally, Electronically, Erstwhile	conjunction/adverb	Connectors, hedges and time markers that join, limit or soften a statement.	*The scheme works, (albeit / insofar as / whereby) only in part; henceforth the rule applies, hitherto it did not, and previously it was optional; (conceivably / presumably / ostensibly) it will change; fundamentally the idea is sound; forms may be filed electronically; the erstwhile chairman said nothing.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Arguably, Purportedly	adverb	as can reasonably be claimed, or as claimed by others without proof	*It is arguably the biggest reform in a decade; the funds were purportedly spent on training.*
Cogent, Grandstanding, Performative, Affirmation, Announcement, Insistence, Memorandum, Interrogation, Caveat, Litany, Querulous	adjective/noun	convincing argument, formal statements, or speaking mainly to be seen.	*His case was cogent, the rest pure (grandstanding / performative) talk; the (affirmation / announcement / memorandum) was read out, his insistence grew, and the interrogation produced a litany of querulous complaints despite one important caveat.*
Confound	verb	to confuse a result by mixing in a hidden cause	*Income differences confounded the study's conclusions.*
Contend, Posit	verb	to put forward a claim or idea as true so it can be debated or tested	*The authors (contend / posit) that growth alone will not cut inequality.*
Eloquent, Lucid, Limpid, Pellucid	adjective	clear, fluent and easy to follow; *eloquent* stresses persuasive skill	*Her (eloquent / lucid / limpid / pellucid) explanation won the house over.*
Elucidate, Delineate, Demonstrate, Indicate, Manifest, Underscore, Promulgate, Emanate, Analyse, Observe	verb	to make something clear, visible, known or pointed out.	*The chart (elucidates / delineates / demonstrates / indicates / manifests) the trend; the study underscored the risk, the ministry*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			promulgated the rule, and the warning emanated from the data they analysed and observed.
Gambit, Machination	noun	a calculated move or secret scheme made to gain advantage	*The walkout was a political gambit; the machinations of the lobby were later exposed.*
Methodology	noun	the set of methods used to carry out research	*The paper's methodology was criticised by statisticians.*
Normative	adjective	about how things should be, based on rules or values, not just how they are	*The report makes a normative case for free school meals.*
Notwithstanding, per se	preposition/phrase	in spite of; and *per se* = in itself, taken on its own	*Notwithstanding the delays, work continued; the rule is not unfair per se.*
Paradox, Dichotomy	noun	a self-contradictory statement, or a sharp split into two opposed parts	*It is a paradox that food-surplus states report hunger; the growth-versus-environment dichotomy dominates the debate.*
Plausible	adjective	believable and reasonable enough to be true	*The explanation is plausible but unproven.*
Qualified, Provisional, Stopgap	adjective	limited, temporary or not final; *qualified* support = support with conditions	*The party gave (qualified / provisional) backing;*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			the ordinance is only a stopgap.
Quandary	noun	a difficult situation where it is hard to decide what to do	*The board faced a quandary over the merger.*
Reiterate	verb	to say something again for emphasis	*The minister reiterated that no tax would rise.*
Replicate	verb	to repeat a study or test to check the result holds	*No team could replicate the original finding.*
Rhetoric, Discourse, Dialectic	noun	public argument and discussion on a topic; *rhetoric* often implies empty persuasive language	*The campaign was heavy on rhetoric; the public discourse and its dialectic of opposing views produced little.*

⚡ Strong Feeling, Energy & Zeal ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Apathetic, Apathy, Jaded, Catharsis, Frustration, Sentimental, Empathy	adjective/noun	feeling nothing, worn out by too much of something, or the release of pent-up emotion.	*Voters have grown (apathetic / jaded); the apathy runs deep, and the verdict brought a strange catharsis after months of frustration.*
Ardent, Zealous, Vociferous	adjective	passionate and forceful in support of something	*He is an (ardent / zealous / vociferous) defender of press freedom. Note: vociferous stresses loudness.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Captivate	verb	to attract and hold someone's attention completely	*Her speech captivated the audience.*
Daunt, Vex, Hubris	verb/noun	to discourage or trouble someone, or the pride that invites a fall	*The scale of the task did not daunt her, though delays continued to vex the team; the collapse was a classic case of hubris.*
Enthusiastic, Confidence, Aspiration, Motivation, Fascination, Attainable	noun/adjective	eagerness, self-belief and the drive to achieve something.	*Her (enthusiasm / confidence / aspiration / motivation) carried the team; the fascination with the goal never faded, and the target proved attainable.*
Invigorate	verb	to give fresh energy to	*The new coach invigorated a tired side.*
Sanguine, Halcyon	adjective	hopeful, or calm and happy	*He stayed sanguine about the outcome; they look back on the halcyon days of the 1990s.*
Vibrant, Kinetic, Robust	adjective	full of energy, movement and strength	*A (vibrant / kinetic) start-up scene and robust demand lifted the city.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Vie, Bid, Competition, Competitive	verb/noun	to try hard to win or obtain something against others.	*Firms (vie / compete) for the contract; the bid was strong, and the competition remained fiercely competitive.*
Zeal	noun	great energy and enthusiasm for a cause	*She campaigned with missionary zeal.*

🔍 Examination, Judgement & Standards ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Scrutinise, Investigate, Probe, Assess, Gauge, Ascertain, Quantify	verb	to examine, measure or establish something; *probe* is also a noun = an investigation	*Auditors (scrutinise / investigate / probe) the accounts to (assess / gauge / ascertain) the loss and (quantify) it.*
Survey, Sample, Data, Ratio, Demographic, Traceability, Examination, Linear, Surveillance	noun/adjective	gathering, counting, tracking and studying information.	*The (survey / sample / data / ratio) showed a clear pattern; the demographic breakdown, traceability of each figure and the examination method were all checked.*
Temperatures	noun	measure of cold or heat, often measurable with a thermometer	*This summer, high temperatures have become inescapable.*

🤝 Agreement, Unity & Cooperation ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Abide, Adhere, Compliance, Accede, Persuade, Co-opt, Stipulate	verb	to follow, agree to, or bring someone round; *compliance* is a noun = the act of obeying, *stipulate* = to set a condition	*Firms must (abide) by and (adhere) to the code, and (compliance) is checked; the state (acceded) to the demand after leaders (persuaded / co-opted) the rebels, and the pact (stipulates) an annual review.*
Accord, Consensus, Coalition, Cohesion, Combination, Convergence, Negotiation, Conference, Parley, Ratification	noun	a coming-together, a deal, or the process of reaching one; *ratification* = the formal approval that makes a deal binding	*After long (negotiation / parley) at the (conference), the (coalition) reached an (accord) by (consensus); the (combination / convergence / cohesion) of views survived (ratification).*
co-/con-, co/con, uni	prefix	prefixes meaning 'with / together' (co-, con-) and 'one' (uni-)	*(co-/con-) gives cooperate, connect, coexist; (co/con) gives collaborate, contract; (uni) gives unite, unique, universe.*
Coalesce, Converge, Reconcile, Mediate, Arbitrate, Convene	verb	to bring or come together, or to settle differences; *mediate* = help two sides agree, *arbitrate* = decide as a neutral judge	*The factions (coalesce / converge) once talks (reconcile) their demands; the panel was (convened) to (mediate / arbitrate) the dispute.*
Cohesive, Compatible, Multilateral, Unilateral,	adjective	united, matching, or added together; *unilateral* = done	*A (cohesive / compatible) team took the (multilateral) route rather than a*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Aggregate, Cumulative, Incremental		alone, *multilateral* = by many together	*(unilateral) one; the (aggregate / cumulative) effect of (incremental) steps was large.*
Rapprochement, Reconciliation, Collaboration, Cooperation, Cooperative, Collective, Acquiesce, Accommodate, Concede, Inclusive, Relationships, Hospitality, Invitation	noun/verb	working together, giving way, or restoring good relations after trouble.	*The talks produced (rapprochement / reconciliation); (collaboration / cooperation) replaced hostility, both sides acquiesced and conceded ground, and the new cooperative accommodated every stakeholder.*
Solidarity	noun	bond of unity or agreement between individuals, united around a common goal or against a common enemy, such as the unifying principle that d	*A long time union member himself, Phil showed solidarity with the picketing grocery store workers by shopping at a competing, unionized store.*

☆ Certainty, Importance & Authority ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Conscription	noun	Involuntary labor, especially military service, demanded by some established authority	*The pair also butted heads over Mr Fedorov's plans to improve recruitment and training to reduce the deep anger created by the conscription system .*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Conspicuous, Palpable, Pronounced, Discernible, Salient, Explicit, Notable, Notifiable, Distinctive, Characteristic, Facet	adjective	easy to see, notice or single out.	*The shift was (conspicuous / palpable / pronounced / discernible / salient); the wording was explicit, the finding (notable / distinctive), and each characteristic facet was set out.*
Electricity	noun	Originally, a property of amber and certain other nonconducting substances to attract lightweight material when rubbed, or the cause of this	*A £2 cap on bus fares, a cut in VAT on electricity, and some business rates relief for pubs, clubs and smaller music venues were all modest moves.*
Impeccable, Inimitable, Irresistible, Epitome, Quintessential, Pristine	adjective/noun	so good that it cannot be faulted or copied. Epitome and quintessential = the perfect example of a type; pristine = spotless or untouched.	*Her record is (impeccable / inimitable / irresistible); she is the (epitome / quintessential example) of a public servant, and the site remains pristine.*
Inescapable	adjective	Impossible to avoid or escape	*This summer, high temperatures have become inescapable.*
Inevitable, Ineluctable, Inexorable, Indubitable, Unequivocal	adjective	certain, unstoppable or beyond doubt; *inexorable* stresses that nothing can halt it	*Defeat looked (inevitable / ineluctable / inexorable); the evidence was (indubitable / unequivocal).*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Inherent, Intrinsic, Innate, Indispensable, Requisite, Cardinal	adjective/noun	belonging to something by its very nature, or absolutely required.	*Risk is (inherent / intrinsic / innate) in the job; trust is (indispensable / requisite) for progress, and openness is a cardinal principle.*
Investigating	verb	inquire into or study in order to ascertain facts or information	*Fire kills 10 members of same family in Peru, police say Authorities are investigating the cause of the blaze in Lima as local media report it may have been arson.*
Jurisdictions	noun	power, right, or authority to interpret and apply the law	*India's foreign policy must look seaward Indian seafarers need protection beyond borders, flags, and jurisdictions*
Paramount, Predominant, Incumbent, Mandate, Remit, Legislative, Democracy, Sovereignty, Autonomy, Privatisation	noun	authority, its scope, or its source; *paramount / predominant* are adjectives = above all others, *incumbent* = the current office-holder or a binding duty	*Safety is (paramount) and the (predominant) concern; the (incumbent) claims a (mandate) within the (remit) of the (legislative) branch, which in a (democracy) rests on (sovereignty) and regional (autonomy); (privatisation) was approved.*
Plastination NEW	noun	technique for preserving bodies or body parts by	*'Dr Death', Body Worlds creator Gunther von Hagens,*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		replacing the water and fat with certain plastics	*dies at 81 The family of the anatomist vowed to carry out his wish for his body to be preserved using the plastination technique he developed himself.*
Unequivocally, Ergo, Hence, Thereby, Thus	adverb	words that link a conclusion to its reason, or state it without doubt	*The data is clear; (ergo / hence / thus / thereby) the policy fails, and the panel (unequivocally) rejected it.*

🌫 Hidden, Unclear & Secret ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Arcane, Cryptic, Esoteric, Recondite, Abstruse	adjective	mysterious, obscure and understood by only a few	*The rules are (arcane / cryptic / esoteric / recondite / abstruse) even to lawyers.*
Clandestine, Furtive	adjective	done secretly to avoid notice, often something illicit	*The (clandestine / furtive) meetings were caught on camera.*
Divulge	verb	to reveal secret information	*The officer refused to divulge the source.*
Gloss over, Belie	verb	to hide or play down something bad so it seems less serious	*The report (glossed over / belied) the true scale of the losses.*
Latent, Underlying	adjective	existing but not yet visible or active; lying beneath the surface	*The (latent / underlying) causes of the unrest went unaddressed.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Obfuscation	noun	deliberately making something confusing to hide the truth	*The reply was pure obfuscation.*
Surreptitious, Inscrutable, Enigmatic, Abscond, Aloof, Insular, Dormant, Liminal, Ineffable	adjective/verb	kept out of sight, held back, or impossible to read or interpret.	*His (surreptitious / inscrutable / enigmatic) conduct raised doubts; he absconded before the inquiry, staying (aloof / insular) from colleagues, while the case sat dormant at a liminal stage.*
Tacit, Implicit	adjective	understood or implied without being said directly	*There was (tacit / implicit) approval from the top.*
Transparent	adjective	letting light through; open and easy to see into (opposite of opaque)	*The process must be transparent and auditable.*
Veneer	noun	a thin, often false, outer appearance	*Beneath the veneer of order lay deep dysfunction.*

 Real, Concrete & Practical ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Tangible, Pragmatic	adjective	real and practical rather than theoretical	*Voters want tangible results and a pragmatic approach.*
Vaccination	noun	giving a vaccine to protect against a disease	*A mass (vaccination) drive covered every district.*

✊ Reject, Revenge & Force ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Depose, Oust, Usurp, Wrest, Annex, Annexation, Coup, Insurrection	verb	to seize power or territory by force, or to throw someone out of it; *annexation / coup / insurrection* are nouns naming such acts	*Generals (deposed / ousted) the president and (usurped / wrested) control in a (coup); the (insurrection) let them (annex) the border district, an (annexation) no one recognised.*
Insurmountable, Indomitable, Impervious, Indefatigable, Tenacious, Incessant, Insatiable, Sustained	adjective	so strong, fixed or persistent that nothing can overcome, affect or exhaust it.	*The lead looked (insurmountable / indomitable); he was impervious to criticism, (indefatigable / tenacious) in his work, and the incessant, insatiable demand was sustained for years.*
Reprisal, Retaliation, Jeopardise, Abrogate, Annul	noun	revenge, or the cancelling / risking of something; *jeopardise* = to put at risk, *abrogate / annul* = to cancel officially	*Fear of (reprisal / retaliation) grew; the strike would (jeopardise) the truce, and parliament moved to (abrogate / annul) the treaty.*

⏳ Time, Lateness & Approach ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Abrupt	adjective	sudden and unexpected	*The scheme came to an abrupt end.*
Accessibility NEW	noun	quality of being accessible, or of admitting approach	*The big three OTTs should lead the march on accessibility*
Belated	adjective	coming later than it should	*A belated apology was issued.*
Bleak, Dismal, Despondent, Lugubrious	adjective	gloomy and without hope; *despondent* describes a person's low mood	*The outlook was (bleak / dismal); relatives looked (despondent / lugubrious) outside the hospital.*
Disenchant	verb	to make someone lose hope or trust	*Voters were disenchanted by the broken promises.*
Ephemeral, Transient	adjective	lasting only a very short time	*The gains proved (ephemeral / transient).*
Harbinger	noun	a sign of something to come	*The rains were a harbinger of a good harvest.*
Juncture, Preliminary, Prevailing, Prospective, Trajectory, Unprecedented, Anticipatory, Precedence, Preparation, Preservation	noun/adjective	words marking when something happens or where it falls in an order.	*At this (juncture) the preliminary stage ended; the prevailing view is that the prospective trajectory is upward, which would be unprecedented; anticipatory planning took precedence over preparation.*
Lull	noun/verb	a quiet or calm period	*There was a brief lull in the fighting.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Sporadic, Peripatetic, Sedentary, Occurrence, Appearance, Disappearance, Destination, Introduction, Inveterate, Capricious, Unpredictable	adjective/noun	how often or how much something moves or happens.	*Attacks were (sporadic / occasional); the peripatetic inspector kept moving while the sedentary staff stayed put; each occurrence, appearance and disappearance was logged.*

🎭 Lies, Trickery & Deception ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Chicanery	noun	clever trickery used to deceive	*The deal was pushed through by legal chicanery.*
Deceive, Dissemble, Beguile, Prevaricate	verb	to mislead by hiding the truth; *beguile* also = to charm; *prevaricate* = to dodge rather than lie outright	*He set out to (deceive / dissemble / beguile) investors; the witness prevaricated for an hour.*
Dubious	adjective	doubtful and possibly not honest or true	*The firm has a dubious record on safety.*
Fabricate	verb	to make up something false	*The dossier was entirely fabricated.*
Mendacious, Duplicitous, Spurious, Specious	adjective	false or dishonest; *specious* = looks correct but is actually false; *duplicitous* = two-faced	*The (mendacious / duplicitous) testimony rested on (spurious / specious) claims.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Sycophant, Sycophancy, Unctuous, Glib, Facile, Servile	noun/adjective	excessive false praise given to win favour, or smooth but hollow speech.	*The court is full of (sycophants / sycophancy); his (glib / unctuous / facile) praise fooled nobody, and the servile staff never disagreed.*

 Problems, Obstacles & Setbacks ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Adversity, Plight, Predicament, Quagmire, Morass, Imbroglio, Conundrum	noun	a difficult, messy or confusing situation	*The migrants' plight worsened; the government is stuck in a (quagmire / morass / imbroglio / predicament) of its own making and faces the conundrum of how to exit; she rose despite great adversity.*
Bane, Disadvantages	noun	a cause of trouble; a drawback	*Corruption is the bane of the system; the disadvantages of the scheme soon became clear.*
Demarcate	verb	to mark out boundaries or limits	*The order demarcates the forest area.*
Grapple, Tackle, Extricate	verb	to struggle with and deal with a difficulty	*The state must (grapple with / tackle) rising debt and extricate itself from bad contracts.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Hurdle, Setback	noun	a problem that blocks or delays progress	*The verdict is a major (hurdle / setback) for the project.*
Jettison	verb	to throw away or abandon something	*The party jettisoned the proposal after the backlash.*
Reprieve, Respite	noun	a short break or relief from trouble	*The rain brought a brief (reprieve / respite) from the heat.*

🧠 Thinking, Reasoning & Memory ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Cite, Warrant, Simulation	verb	to give as a reason or justify it; *simulation* is a noun = a modelled run used to predict behaviour	*Officials (cite) new data that (warrants) a review, backed by a computer (simulation).*
flect/flex, flu/flux, ject, spec/spect	root	Latin roots: flect/flex = bend, flu/flux = flow, ject = throw, spec/spect = see or look	*(flect/flex) gives reflect, flexible; (flu/flux) gives fluent, influx; (ject) gives reject, eject; (spec/spect) gives inspect, spectator.*
Mull, Deliberate, Reckon, Infer, Discern, Anticipation, Experience	verb	to think, work out or perceive; *deliberate* also = done on purpose (adj.), *anticipation / experience* are nouns for expecting and for what you have lived through	*The board will (mull / deliberate) the plan and (reckon) the cost; from the data you can (infer / discern) a trend; (anticipation) ran high, and (experience) shaped the verdict.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Surmise, Postulate, Extrapolate, Speculation, Speculative, Hypothesis, Projection, Derive, Dwell, Synthesis, Reminiscent, Epistemic, Consciousness, Intelligence	verb/noun	to work something out, guess it from clues, or turn it over in the mind.	*Analysts (surmise / postulate / extrapolate) from thin data; the (hypothesis / projection / speculation) is speculative at best, though it derives from real evidence; he dwelt on it for weeks before offering a synthesis.*

⚖️ Fairness, Honesty & Truth ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Candid, Forthright, Veracious	adjective	honest, direct and truthful in what one says	*She gave a (candid / forthright / veracious) account of the failures.*
Credible, Tenable, Evidence, Fidelity, Exculpate, Exoneration, Unanimous	adjective/noun	believable, defensible or backed by proof; also being cleared of blame.	*The claim is (credible / tenable) and the evidence supports it; his fidelity to the facts was total, the inquiry exculpated him, and the exoneration was unanimous.*
Devout	adjective	deeply religious or sincerely committed	*He was a devout follower of the movement.*
Equitable	adjective	fair and just to all	*The panel urged a more equitable sharing of river water.*
Hindsight	noun	understanding a situation only after it	*In hindsight, the warning signs were*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		has happened	*obvious.*
Lenient, Forbearance	adjective/noun	not strict; patient and self-controlled in the face of provocation	*The judge was lenient; the state showed unusual forbearance.*
Mitigation	noun	action taken to make a problem less serious	*Flood mitigation works were funded this year.*
Partisan, Divisive	adjective	one-sided and splitting people into hostile camps	*The bill was (partisan / divisive) from the start.*
Redress, Rectify	verb/noun	to correct or set right a wrong	*The tribunal exists to (redress / rectify) such grievances.*
Repatriate	verb	to send someone back to their own country	*Hundreds of workers were repatriated after the war.*
Rescind	verb	to cancel or take back an order or decision	*The ministry rescinded the circular within a week.*
Sanctimonious, Histrionic, Grandiose	adjective	putting on a false show - of moral superiority, of emotion, or of grandeur	*The speech was (sanctimonious / histrionic / grandiose) and short on detail.*
Veracity	noun	truthfulness; accuracy (root VER = truth)	*The court questioned the veracity of the affidavit.*

Hostility, Bitterness & Stubbornness ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Animosity, Acrimony, Rancour	noun	strong bitter hostility and resentment	*The talks collapsed amid (animosity /*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		between people	*acrimony / rancour).*
Dissolute, Licentious	adjective	behaving without moral restraint	*The court described his (dissolute / licentious) conduct.*
Forge	verb	to build or create a bond; or, in the other sense, to fake a document	*The two states forged a water-sharing pact; he was jailed for forging signatures.*
Hostile, Inimical, Virulent, Vituperative	adjective	showing strong enmity or doing active harm; *vituperative* = bitterly abusive in words	*The climate was (hostile / inimical) to investment; his (virulent / vituperative) attacks drew censure.*
Indelible	adjective	impossible to remove or erase	*The riots left an indelible mark on the city.*
Labyrinthine	adjective	extremely complicated and confusing, like a maze	*The subsidy rules are labyrinthine.*
Recalcitrant, Implacable	adjective	stubbornly refusing to obey or to be calmed	*The (recalcitrant / implacable) faction blocked every compromise.*

👑 Power, Control & Influence ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Appointment	noun	act of appointing a person to hold an office or to have a position of trust	*One of Sir Keir Starmer's last acts as prime minister was to approve the appointment of her successor, Jessica*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			Morgan , a former curator at Tate and head of the Dia Art Foundation in New York.
Clout, Hegemony, Wield, Capacity, Propensity	noun	power or influence and the ability to use it; *wield* is a verb = to hold and use power, *propensity* = a natural tendency	*A bloc with real (clout) exercises (hegemony) and (wields) it freely, given the (capacity) to act and a (propensity) to intervene.*
Interlocutor, Palliative, Tariff	noun	instruments or roles used to manage a situation; *palliative* = a stop-gap that relieves but does not cure	*An (interlocutor) was appointed; the relief package was a mere (palliative), and the (tariff) stayed in place.*

😀 Hope, Calm & Positivity ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Ameliorate	verb	to make a bad situation better	*The grant helped ameliorate rural distress.*
Assuage, Mollify, Placate	verb	to calm or soothe someone who is angry or upset	*The package was meant to (assuage / mollify / placate) the protesters.*
Buoyant, Jubilant, Jovial, Genial	adjective	cheerful and in high spirits; *buoyant* also = economically strong	*The crowd was (jubilant / jovial); the host was genial and markets stayed buoyant.*
Geographical	noun	move to another place in the hope of	*Iran now understands the powerful leverage*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		curing an addiction etc	*of the strait and its geographical, and therefore military, advantage in controlling it.*
Impressive	adjective	Making, or tending to make, a positive impression	*On the Grand Road of Puri The Jagannatha temple in the city in Odisha is an impressive place of worship, and the grand festival of the deity is incomparable*
Phlegmatic, Nonchalant	adjective	calm and unbothered, showing little emotion or concern	*He remained (phlegmatic / nonchalant) through the crisis.*
Quixotic	adjective	unrealistic and impractical in a hopeful, idealistic way	*It was a quixotic bid for the presidency.*

🌑 Bad, Harmful & Unpleasant ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Adverse, Detrimental, Deleterious, Noxious, Baleful, Ominous, Grim, Harrowing, Lachrymose	adjective	harmful, threatening or deeply unpleasant; *noxious* = poisonous, *ominous / baleful* = warning of coming evil, *lachrymose* = tearful	*(Adverse / detrimental / deleterious / noxious) fumes filled the street; the (baleful / ominous / grim) forecast made for a (harrowing), (lachrymose) night.*
Cacophony, Embarrassments	noun	an unpleasant clash of sound, or acute discomfort	*A (cacophony) of horns drowned the speech, adding to the*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			government's (embarrassments).
Draconian, Stark, Incendiary, Wanton, Galvanic	adjective	extremely harsh, blunt or inflaming	*The (draconian) order and its (stark) wording were (incendiary); (wanton) destruction followed, with a (galvanic) effect on protesters.*
Endemic, Subprime, Ineffective	adjective	a settled or low-grade bad condition; *endemic* = always present in a place or group, *subprime* = high-risk and poor quality	*Corruption is (endemic) here; (subprime) lending and (ineffective) oversight caused the crash.*
Futile	adjective	useless because it cannot work	*Further talks would be futile.*
Insidious, Insidiously, Pernicious, Malignant, Malevolent, Vindictive, Machinations	adjective	harmful in a hidden, spiteful or scheming way; *insidiously* is the adverb, *machinations* a noun = secret harmful plotting	*(Insidious / pernicious / malignant) rumours spread (insidiously); (malevolent / vindictive) rivals and their (machinations) did the rest.*
mal-	prefix	prefix meaning 'bad' or 'badly'	*(mal-) gives malfunction, malnutrition, maltreat.*
Negligence, Impunity, Contaminate, Inadvertent, Inappropriate, Unacceptable, Unacknowledged, Profane	noun/adjective/verb	failing in a duty, or acting in a way that damages, pollutes or offends.	*The (negligence / impunity) was inexcusable; officials contaminated the site, acted (inadvertently / inappropriately), and used profane, unacceptable*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			language that went unacknowledged.
Squalid, Putrid, Macabre, Brittle, Desiccation, Malnutrition	adjective/noun	filthy, rotting, brittle or grimly unpleasant.	*Families live in (squalid / putrid) conditions; the macabre scene shocked inspectors; the brittle pipes and desiccation of the soil worsened malnutrition.*

📦 Amount, Size & Plenty ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Abound	verb	to exist in large numbers; to be plentiful	*Rumours abound about a cabinet reshuffle.*
Abundant, Ample, Copious, Profuse	adjective	existing in large, more-than-enough quantities	*The region has (abundant / ample / copious / profuse) rainfall.*
Affordability	noun	extent to which something is affordable, as measured by its cost relative to the amount that the purchaser is able to pay	*First-time home buyers are feeling the squeeze of higher interest rates with mortgage affordability at its worst level for 16 years.*
Avarice	noun	extreme greed for wealth	*Corporate avarice drove the collapse.*
Average, Approximate	noun/adjective	the typical middle value; close to but not exactly correct	*The average yield was about four tonnes, an*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			approximate figure at best.
Concise, Laconic	adjective	using very few words; short and clear	*His reply was (concise / laconic).*
Dearth, Paucity	noun	a serious shortage or very small amount of something	*There is a (dearth / paucity) of reliable district-level data.*
Decimate	verb	to destroy a large part of something; stronger than *reduce*	*The drought decimated the cattle herd.*
Deficient, Meagre, Marginal	adjective	not enough; very small in amount	*The diet was (deficient / meagre); the gains were marginal.*
Exorbitant, Hefty	adjective	far too high or large in price, amount or weight	*Patients were charged (exorbitant / hefty) fees.*
Extraordinary, Existential, Evacuation, Ammunition	adjective/noun	how far something reaches, or how far outside the ordinary it falls.	*The response was (extraordinary / existential) in scale; the evacuation used all the ammunition and manpower available.*
Panacea	noun	a supposed cure for all problems (usually said it is NOT one)	*Technology is no panacea for rural poverty.*
Plethora, Surfeit, Myriad	noun	a very large number or an excess of something	*The scheme drew a (plethora / surfeit / myriad) of complaints.*
Stifle	verb	to stop something from developing or being expressed	*The law stifles dissent.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Substantial	adjective	large in size or amount	*A substantial share of the budget went unspent.*
Superfluous, Redundant	adjective	more than is needed; unnecessary	*The clause was (superfluous / redundant) and was dropped.*
Surplus	noun	the extra amount left when income is more than spending	*The state recorded a revenue surplus this year.*
Unbridled, Unfettered	adjective	not controlled or held back; without limits	*(Unbridled / Unfettered) construction choked the wetland.*

□ Difference, Comparison & Opposite ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Antithesis, Converse	noun	the exact opposite of something	*His conduct is the (antithesis / converse) of everything the office stands for.*
Difference	noun	the quality of being unlike; a disparity	*The difference between the two states is stark.*
Dwarf	verb	to make something else look small by comparison	*The new plant dwarfs every rival in the region.*

 Catch, Hold & Seize ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
cap/cept, ten/tain, duc/duct, fract/frag, de-, vac	root	word roots and prefixes that build many editorial words	*cap/cept = take (capture, accept); ten/tain = hold (retain, contain); duc/duct = lead (conduct, induce); fract/frag = break (fracture, fragment); de- = down or remove (decrease, devalue); vac = empty (vacant, evacuate).*
Nab	verb	to catch or arrest someone	*Police nabbed the suspect at the airport.*

📌 Cause, Effect & Consequence ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Adjacent, Contiguous, Contingent, Dependence, Implication, Comprise, Factor in, Correspondents, Alternative, Circumstances, Considerations, Considerable, Stakeholder, Manifold	adjective/noun	lying next to, linked with, or relying on something else.	*The two plots are (adjacent / contiguous); the payout is contingent on audit, the dependence on imports is total, and every implication must be factored in.*
Administered	verb	cause to ingest , either by openly offering or through deceit	*The other half is provided and administered by limited-profit housing associations – an Austrian version of*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			social housing providers that are permitted to make a small profit to finance their operations.
Aftermath, Fallout, Outcome, Ramification, Repercussion, Corollary	noun	what follows from an event; *corollary* = something that logically follows, *repercussion / fallout* = the indirect bad after-effects	*In the (aftermath), the (fallout / repercussions / ramifications) were severe; the (outcome) was a natural (corollary) of the decision.*
Allegiance	noun	Loyalty to some cause, nation or ruler	*Now it shows how flimsy that allegiance is It's the World Cup final , so you pick a side.*
Consequential	adjective	Following as a result	*The most consequential fixture in international sport was, as it turned out, little more than a grand cosplay for the New Jersey leisure market.*
Engender, Breed, Inflict, Wreak, Attribute, Causation, Factor	verb	to cause or produce something, or to name the cause; *causation / factor* are nouns = the causal link and a contributing cause	*Delay (engenders / breeds) anger and (inflicts / wreaks) real damage; analysts (attribute) this to one (factor), though (causation) is unproven.*
Hinge, Entail, Offset	verb	to depend on, require, or balance out	*Success (hinges) on funding, which (entails) new taxes;*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			savings elsewhere (offset) the cost.

🔺 Highest & Lowest Points ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Nadir	noun	the lowest or worst point	*Relations between the two countries hit their nadir that year.*
Zenith, Heyday, Culminate	noun/verb	the highest or most successful point	*The party was at its (zenith / heyday) in 1984; the protests culminated in a march on the capital.*

🗨️ Talkative, Loud & Wordy ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Bombastic, Grandiloquent, Turgid, Florid	adjective	high-sounding, inflated and empty in language	*The speech was (bombastic / grandiloquent / turgid / florid) but said nothing new.*
Garrulous, Loquacious	adjective	talking far too much	*A (garrulous / loquacious) witness held up the hearing.*

Boldness, Recklessness & Daring ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Audacious, Intrepid	adjective	very bold and fearless, sometimes shockingly so	*It was an (audacious / intrepid) rescue attempt.*
Impetuous, Headlong	adjective/adverb	acting fast without thinking; rushing in recklessly	*The impetuous decision was made headlong, without consulting anyone.*

😨 Shyness, Caution & Restraint ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Astute, Perspicacious	adjective	clever and shrewd, with sharp insight	*It was an (astute / perspicacious) reading of the market.*
Diffident, Reticent, Reluctant, Circumspect	adjective	holding back - through shyness, unwillingness, or careful caution	*He was (diffident / reticent / reluctant) about speaking; the ministry stayed circumspect on the figures.*
Keen	adjective	eager, or sharply aware and perceptive	*She was keen to start, and had a keen eye for detail.*
Taciturn	adjective	habitually saying very little	*The taciturn official gave one-word answers.*

□ Unity, Sameness & Division ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Consecutive	noun	sequence of notes or chords that results	*US renews strikes on Iran as Trump*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		from repeated shifts in pitch of the same interval	*threatens to attack underground nuclear site The US president's threat to target a key Iranian nuclear site came ahead of the 11th consecutive night of attacks.*
Homogeneous, Concurrent, Discrete	adjective	alike, simultaneous, or separately distinct	*The sample was homogeneous; the two trials were concurrent; the syllabus is split into discrete units.*
Juxtapose	verb	to place things side by side for comparison	*The film juxtaposes rural poverty with urban excess.*

🌟 Quality, Character & Behaviour ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Accidentally, Unintentionally	adverb	without meaning to	*The file was (accidentally / unintentionally) deleted.*
Administrations	noun	act of administering	*Heads of devolved administrations are also adept at claiming credit when things go well and, when they go badly, diverting the blame on to national government.*
Affable, Amiable, Cordial, Gregarious,	adjective	pleasant, warm and easy to get on with. Suave and urbane	*The host was (affable / amiable / cordial / gregarious); his (suave*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Suave, Urbane, Amity		add smooth social polish; gregarious = fond of company.	*/ urbane) manner put everyone at ease.*
Authentic, bona fide	adjective	genuine and real, not fake	*The manuscript is (authentic / bona fide).*
Availability	noun	quality of being available	*Salad for breakfast is "not normal in a northern European climate", according to one agitated typer in a response to my post about its availability at breakfasts there.*
Brusque	adjective	abrupt and rude in manner	*His brusque reply ended the meeting.*
Coherent, Comprehensive, Germane, Pertinent	adjective	clear, complete and to the point	*We need a (coherent / comprehensive) policy; only (germane / pertinent) evidence was admitted.*
Controversially, Horrendously, Excruciatingly, Architecturally	adverb	adverbs of manner formed from common editorial adjectives	*Controversially, the bench went further; the scheme was horrendously mismanaged; progress was excruciatingly slow; architecturally, the building is a landmark.*
Environmentally	adverb	In a manner affecting the environment	*Buried questions: On the Sikkim tunnel accident The costs of projects in environmentally fragile zones are many*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Excellence	noun	quality of being excellent	*Indian Monsoon: a democratic tipping point Our future depends upon combining technological excellence with constitutional values, scientific temper, ethical leadership, and respect for humanity*
Fastidious, Pedantic, Pernickety	adjective	overly concerned with small details, rules or standards.	*His (fastidious / pedantic / pernickety) checking slowed the whole process.*
Haughty, Supercilious, Imperious, Pompous, Pretentious, Insolent, Churlish, Obstreperous, Gauche	adjective	behaving as if better than everyone else, or plainly ill-mannered.	*The minister's (haughty / supercilious / imperious / pompous / pretentious) reply angered the house; his (insolent / churlish / obstreperous) aide was worse, and the new recruit was merely gauche.*
Historically	adverb	In a historic manner	*The country's historically mild climate allowed developers to build houses without insulation, while industrialisation supplied plentiful coal to burn when temperatures dropped.*
Illusory, Ostensible, Elusive	adjective	not what it appears to be, or hard to pin	*The gains proved (illusory / ostensible);*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		down	*a lasting settlement remains elusive.*
Immaculate, Exemplary, Paragon, Incomparable	noun/adjective	faultless; a perfect model of excellence	*His record is (immaculate / exemplary); she is a paragon of public service and, in her field, incomparable.*
Importance, Endorsement	noun	worth or note, and public backing	*The court stressed the importance of the right; the campaign won a celebrity endorsement.*
Improvisational	adjective	Having the nature of an improvisation	*A Soviet-schooled military officer deeply embedded within institutions tussled with a young civilian disruptor taking a more agile, improvisational approach.*
Irresponsibility	noun	the state of not being answerable for one's actions	*The report blamed official irresponsibility for the lapse.*
Legitimacy, de jure	noun/adjective	rightful and lawful standing	*The government's legitimacy was questioned; de jure the office is elected, in practice it is not.*
Neighbourhood	noun	quality of being a neighbor, of living nearby, next to each-other	*Across the capital, there were 35,000 fewer "neighbourhood crimes" – a category which includes burglaries, thefts, robberies and vehicle*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			crime offences – in the past 12 months than in the year before.
Perilously NEW	adverb	In a perilous manner	*We unpack whether its "arsenal of freedom" is perilously low.*
Possibilities	noun	quality of being possible	*Many people are enjoying healthier, richer lives for longer, and redefining the meaning and possibilities of old age.*
Pulchritude, Mellifluous, Euphony, Embellish, Entertainment, Performance	noun/adjective/verb	physically beautiful, sweet to the ear, or made more attractive.	*Her (pulchritude / mellifluous voice) drew crowds; the euphony of the hall was perfect, the stage was embellished, and the entertainment and performance were flawless.*
Pusillanimous	adjective	cowardly and lacking courage	*The pusillanimous response emboldened the attackers.*
Sanitation, Eligibility	noun	public-service terms: waste management, and the right to qualify	*Sanitation coverage rose sharply; eligibility for the scheme was widened.*

Other & Mixed ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Acceptable	adjective	Worthy, decent, sure of being accepted or	*We need to find an acceptable present for*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		received with at least moderate pleasure	*Jeff.*
Accountable	adjective	Obliged, when called upon, to answer	*The Grim Lessons of Israel's War in Gaza Israel has not been held accountable for its actions in Gaza.*
Acknowledgments	noun	act of acknowledging	*Conservatives who critique land acknowledgments aren't acting in good faith, but they do have a point.*
Announcements	noun	act of announcing, or giving notice	*If Mr Burnham agrees, he will have to wait before making any big announcements.*
Apocalyptic	noun	One who predicts apocalypse	*Given the somewhat apocalyptic conditions, getting dressed to go to the office is the last thing anyone wants to think about, mainly because it feels wrong to be working.*
Artificial	adjective	Man-made	*Race Open-weight models have been the underlying strength of Chinese artificial intelligence strategy.*
Astonishment	noun	feeling or experience of being astonished	*But in this role, to general astonishment, he placed the public good above special interests.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Catastrophic NEW	adjective	Of or pertaining to a catastrophe	*Wildfire now nine miles from French city of Bordeaux, mayor warns Thomas Cazenave says they are preparing if further evacuations are issued, as the mayor of a nearby town called the situation "catastrophic".*
Civilization	noun	organized culture encompassing many communities, often on the scale of a nation or a people	*Three speeches on a single day signaled a dying American democracy | Robert Shpiner Stephen Miller warned of a leftwing 'cancer' threatening civilization.*
Commercial	noun	advertisement in a common media format, usually radio or television	*The last time America hosted, the problem wasn't commercial overkill so much as sheer shrugging apathy.*
Complications, Renovation	noun	act or process of complicating	*Teen jailed for exam cheating in Guinea dies after sickle cell complications, father says Mamadou Djouma Bah, 17, was arrested and sentenced to prison for exam fraud earlier this month.*
Consideration	noun	thought process of considering, of taking	*After much consideration, I have*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		multiple or specified factors into account	*decided to stay.*
Containment NEW	noun	state of being contained	*A pyrocumulonimbus is a fire-generated thunderstorm that can whip up winds in unpredictable ways, making the containment of a blaze and assessment of its likely course far more difficult.*
Contradiction, Contradictions	noun	act of contradicting	*The apparent contradiction – fortifying the centre to pursue an agenda of decentralisation – arises from a perversity in the way the British state works or, rather, fails to work* .
Decentralisation	noun	action of decentralizing, or the state of being decentralized	*The apparent contradiction – fortifying the centre to pursue an agenda of decentralisation – arises from a perversity in the way the British state works or, rather, fails to work* .
Democratic NEW	adjective	Pertaining to democracy	*Indian Monsoon: a democratic tipping point Our future depends upon combining technological*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			excellence with constitutional values, scientific temper, ethical leadership, and respect for humanity
Demonstrations	noun	act of demonstrating	*Students and others have continued their demonstrations despite allegations of state excesses.*
Destabilize	verb	make something unstable	*Haiti Needs Stability, Not Mass Deportations Deporting Haitian migrants will further destabilize a country in crisis.*
Deterrence NEW	noun	act of deterring, or the state of being deterred	*Beyond the brink: Why deterrence has broken down in West Asia*
Devastation NEW	noun	act of devastating, or the state of being devastated	*The dire statistics of the ongoing fires in France and Spain tell a story of deepening devastation and human misery.*
Devolution	noun	rolling down	*But genuine control, especially when it comes to fiscal policy, has not matched the rhetoric of devolution.*
Disagreements NEW	noun	argument or debate	*The reputation for infighting in lefty spaces – where policy disagreements harden into personal tests of*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			morality – needs neither introduction nor encouragement.
Distraction	noun	Something that distracts	*Poking one's eye is a good distraction from a hurting toe.*
Distribution	noun	act of distributing or state of being distributed	*Lists of folly: On the Supreme Court, the SIR and benefits A flawed SIR should not be the basis for distribution of benefits*
Educational	noun	free trip for travel consultants, provided by a travel operator or airline as a means of promoting their service	*India cockroach protests: Videos show officers firing 'pellet guns' Thousands of people have taken to the streets in Delhi as part of the cockroach protests, calling for educational reforms.*
Encouragement	noun	act of encouraging	*The reputation for infighting in lefty spaces – where policy disagreements harden into personal tests of morality – needs neither introduction nor encouragement.*
Environment	noun	surroundings of, and influences on, a particular item of interest	*There's a slightly mean question I often ask British people with an interest in the living world: can you name the environment secretary?*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Exhibition	noun	instance of exhibiting, or something exhibited	*Ten killed in Russian attack on drone exhibition near Kyiv The event, attended by prominent members of the Ukrainian defence industry, was hit by ballistic missiles in the middle of the day.*
Exploitation	noun	act of utilizing something	*Through the VRU, we've done just that, providing interventions and positive opportunities to prevent more than half a million young people from getting caught up in a vicious cycle of violence and exploitation.*
Facilitating	verb	make easy or easier	*But rather than stop it, the government has been facilitating it.*
Fashionable NEW	noun	fashionable person	*Tate Britain, often overshadowed by its more fashionable younger sister, pulled in crowds for its Turner & Constable and Lee Miller exhibitions.*
Homelessness	noun	state of being homeless	*But I wasn't in the space of wanting to play semantics with it." Daniel Lavelle writes on mental health,*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			homelessness and social care.
Impossible	noun	impossibility	*An article in the Observer concluded that Vienna shows "decent homes for all" is not an impossible dream.*
Improbable	adjective	Not likely to be true	*The garish half-time show curated by Chris Martin of Coldplay seemed to reinforce that – but then came a moment of improbable genius.*
Improvisation	noun	act or art of composing and making music, poetry, and the like, extemporaneously	*Since the Odyssey is the result of decades, maybe centuries, of non-literate oral poets working with memory and improvisation, there's no precise "original" place or time to return to, anyway.*
Incongruities	noun	state of being incongruous, or lacking congruence	*The MetLife Stadium on Sunday night was a melting pot of colliding incongruities and temporary identities.*
Independent	noun	candidate or voter not affiliated with any political party, a freethinker, free of a party platform	*Diana Berg is a Ukrainian artist, writer and cultural manager from Mariupol, and the founder of Platform TU, an independent cultural*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			initiative now operating in exile after Russia's full-scale invasion.
Initiative	noun	beginning	*Battling drug abuse: On Kerala's Operation Toofan Kerala has shown initiative in coordinated action against cartels*
Inspiration	noun	drawing of air into the lungs, accomplished in mammals by elevation of the chest walls and flattening of the diaphragm, as part of the act o	*Fast fashion and mall brands used to look to the runways for inspiration.*
Installation	noun	act of installing	*My street now resembles an art installation, with varying colours and patterns of bed sheets taped to windows in the battle against the heat.*
Institutions, Institution	noun	custom or practice of a society or community	*A Soviet-schooled military officer deeply embedded within institutions tussled with a young civilian disruptor taking a more agile, improvisational approach.*
Instruction NEW	noun	act of instructing, teaching, or furnishing with	*Instruction will be provided on how to*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		information or knowledge	*handle difficult customers.*
Insubstantial NEW	adjective	Lacking substance	*Indeed, within hours of becoming prime minister, some familiar predators were circling as they tried to decide whether to attack him for being too leftwing, too insubstantial or simply offering more of the same.*
Insulation	noun	act of insulating	*The country's historically mild climate allowed developers to build houses without insulation, while industrialisation supplied plentiful coal to burn when temperatures dropped.*
Intellectuals	noun	intelligent, learned person, especially one who discourses about learned matters	*In the early 20th century, Chinese intellectuals sought to capture the harsh realities of working-class lives.*
Intergenerational	adjective	Between or across generations	*But the statistics and direction of travel also point to immense social challenges, with implications for the way we work, intergenerational fairness and the future funding of care.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Interventions	noun	action of intervening	*Through the VRU, we've done just that, providing interventions and positive opportunities to prevent more than half a million young people from getting caught up in a vicious cycle of violence and exploitation.*
Investigators NEW	noun	One who investigates	*South Africa investigates death of Nigerian who collapsed during arrest Initial reports from a post-mortem said he had "abrasions on his back and chest", investigators say.*
Investment	noun	act of investing, or state of being invested	*The CETA can reshape trade and investment flows, create quality jobs and growth, and transition India to a more competitive and innovation-driven economy*
Journalist	noun	keeper of a personal journal, who writes in it regularly	*María Ramírez is a journalist and deputy managing editor of elDiario.es, a news outlet in Spain Do you have an opinion on the issues raised in this article?*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Miscalculated NEW	verb	calculate incorrectly	*All art, no deal: On the U.S.-Saudi Arabia nuclear deal Trump miscalculated timing and substance of Saudi nuclear deal*
Opportunistic	adjective	Taking advantage of situations that arise	*Ghanaians' ICC petition over migrant attacks 'opportunistic', says South Africa The petition argues the violence against migrants in South Africa could amount to crimes against humanity.*
Pessimistic	adjective	Marked by pessimism and little hopefulness	*So many British people have it better than they think – it's up to Burnham to make them see that | Polly Toynbee A new survey suggests voters are becoming more cynical and pessimistic.*
Photographing	verb	take a photograph of	*On a crowded train of people mostly staring obliviously at our own phones, a stranger had been covertly photographing that little girl over and over again.*
Preference	noun	selection of one thing or person over others	*Yet Burnham's support for the government's suffocating fiscal rules – and his preference*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			for the vaguer language of "public control" over public ownership – had already raised doubts about how far he was prepared to go.
Presumption	noun	act of presuming, or something presumed	*As a critical care doctor, I have a response to his diagnosis The presumption that US elections are legitimate died last week in Washington.*
Progressives	noun	person who actively favors or strives for progress towards improved conditions, as in society or government	*That a self-described leftwing party could have such success by fixing on Mexico's chasmic inequality has drawn attention from hopeful progressives worldwide.*
Prominence	noun	state of being prominent	*Reforms in recent years have created institutions with varying degrees of local autonomy – elected mayoralties like the one in Manchester that afforded Mr Burnham a platform for national prominence.*
Pronouncements	noun	official public announcement	*Following her latest pronouncements, Badenoch has*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			effectively committed the Conservatives to a policy of conflict, and possibly even rupture, with the EU.
Psychological	adjective	Of or pertaining to psychology	*Obsessing About Our Mental Health Is Part of Our Mental Health Problem We need to support psychological well-being without fixating on it.*
Punishment	noun	act or process of punishing, imposing and/or applying a sanction	*Voters reserve the greatest punishment for the politicians they think acted too little, or too late, to prevent them getting poorer.*
Questionable	adjective	Problematic	*That was always a questionable assertion, given the defining postwar role of Labour in shaping a fairer social settlement.*
Reproductive	noun	reproductive organism	*That this was the final straw for his party revealed how, in the conservative Germany of today, reproductive politics can mark a red line.*
Sensibilities NEW	noun	ability to sense, feel or perceive	*But how far should modern moral sensibilities influence adaptations of classics?*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Significance	noun	extent to which something matters	*Social care has personal significance for Mr Burnham.*
Strategist	noun	Someone who devises strategies	*Katz, the political strategist behind candidates like Zohran Mamdani, John Fetterman and Graham Platner, makes the case for the party to embrace a more populist platform on "The Ezra Klein Show."*
Subordinate NEW	noun	One who is subordinate	*To fix unemployment, fix the economy first The 'ease of doing business' must now become subordinate to the ease of living and earning for all citizens*
Thunderstorms NEW	noun	storm consisting of thunder and lightning produced by a cumulonimbus, usually accompanied with heavy rain, wind, and sometimes hail	*How 'fire-generated thunderstorms' make wildfires more deadly Certain types of severe wildfire can create pyrocumulonimbus - something that Nasa calls the "fire-breathing dragon of clouds".*
Traditional	noun	person with traditional beliefs	*"I wasn't making what you would call a traditional target," the mayor said.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Unemployment 🆕	noun	state of having no job	*To fix unemployment, fix the economy first The 'ease of doing business' must now become subordinate to the ease of living and earning for all citizens*
Uninhabitable	adjective	Not fit for people to live in	*The earthquake left many homes in the area uninhabitable.*

🧬 Word Roots, Prefixes & Latin Phrases ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
a priori, de facto, per capita, inter alia, nota bene, prima facie, pro rata, status quo, vice versa, vis-a-vis, ad hoc	phrase	Set Latin and formal expressions common in editorial, legal and economic writing.	*A priori reasoning needs no data; a de facto ruler holds power without the title; income is compared per capita; the report lists, inter alia, three reforms; nota bene, the deadline is fixed; funds are shared pro rata; prima facie the case stands; the status quo remains; vis-a-vis last year growth is slower, and vice versa applies too; the panel was set up on an ad hoc basis.*
bene, bene-	prefix	bene and bene- mean 'good' or 'well'.	*The root (bene / bene-) gives benefit,*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			benefactor and benevolent.
bio, vita/viv, nat, gen, carn, anthrop, mort, geo, hydro, therm, photo, path	root	Greek/Latin roots about living things and the natural world: bio & vita/viv = life, nat = born, gen = birth or race, carn = flesh, anthrop = human, mort = death, geo = earth, hydro = water, therm = heat, photo = light, path = feeling or disease.	*Roots unlock new words: (bio) gives biology, (geo) gives geography, (mort) gives mortality.*
mono, bi, tri, semi-, multi, poly, omni, max, min, over-, under-, equ	prefix	Prefixes showing how many or how much: mono = one, bi = two, tri = three, semi- = half, multi/poly = many, omni = all, max = greatest, min = small or less, over- = too much, under- = too little, equ = equal.	*Add the prefix (mono / bi / tri) to get monorail, bicycle and triangle.*
port, fer, tract, mit/miss, vert/vers, pos/pon, rupt, scrib/script, graph/gram	root	Roots about carrying, moving, writing and breaking: port, fer and tract = carry or pull, mit/miss = send, vert/vers = turn, pos/pon = place or put, rupt = break, scrib/script and graph/gram = write or draw.	*The root (port / fer / tract) gives transport, transfer and tractor.*
pre-, fore-, post-, ex-, sub-, inter-,	prefix	Prefixes showing position or time: pre-	*The prefix (pre- / post- / trans-) fixes time or*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
intra-, trans-, tele		and fore- = before or front, post- = after, ex- = out or former, sub- = under or below, inter- = between, intra- = within, trans- = across, tele = far.	*direction: preview, postwar, transport.*
psych, cogn, sci, fid, sens/sent, aud, vid/vis, phon, doc, phil, am/amor, chron, chrono, ann/enn, auto	root	Roots about the mind, knowing, trusting and the senses: psych = mind, cogn & sci = know, fid = faith or trust, sens/sent = feel, aud = hear, vid/vis = see, phon = sound, doc = teach, phil & am/amor = love, chron/chrono = time, ann/enn = year, auto = self.	*The root (psych / cogn / vid-vis) appears in psychology, recognise and vision; (fid) gives fidelity, and (ann/enn) gives annual.*
un-, non-, in-/im-/il-/ir-, anti-	prefix	Prefixes that reverse or oppose a meaning: un-, non- and in-/im-/il-/ir- all mean 'not'; anti- means 'against'.	*Put (un- / non- / in-im-il-ir-) before a word to negate it: unhappy, non-stop, impossible.*

🏛 Polity, Government & Civics ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Conservative, Progressive, Revolutionary, Maverick, Iconoclast,	noun/adjective	people and powers defined by their political stance or dominance.	*A (conservative / progressive / revolutionary) wing formed; the maverick iconoclast defied the*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Hegemon, Gerontocracy, Envoy, Geopolitical, International, Pariah			*hegemon, the gerontocracy sent an envoy, and the pariah state was frozen out of geopolitical talks.*
Franchise, Suffrage, Electorate, Constituency, Plebiscite, Gerrymander, Delimitation, Registration, Representation, Representatives, Participation, Grassroots, Mobilisation	noun/verb	the right to vote and the machinery of elections and representation.	*Every adult has the (franchise / suffrage); the electorate of each constituency voted in a plebiscite, though delimitation was gerrymandered; registration, participation and grassroots mobilisation decide who the representatives are and how good the representation is.*
Governance, Legislation, Regulation, Constitution, Constitutional, Unconstitutional, Parliament, Parliamentary, Polity, Jurisprudence, Impeachment, Prosecution, Enforcement, Administrative, Institutional, Institutionalised, Establishment, Inspectorate, Presidential, Tenet	noun/adjective	the bodies, rules, offices and processes by which a state is run.	*Good (governance / legislation / regulation) rests on the constitution; parliament debates it, the polity accepts it, and jurisprudence interprets it; impeachment, prosecution and enforcement follow when constitutional limits are broken.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Nationalism, Xenophobia, Antisemitism, Diaspora, Asylum, Immigration, Indigenous, Civilisation, Radicalization, Partisanship, Ideological	noun/adjective	ideas about who belongs to a nation, who is kept out, and who leads it.	*Rising (nationalism / xenophobia / antisemitism) hardened attitudes; the diaspora sought asylum, immigration dominated debate, and indigenous claims were ignored as radicalization and partisanship grew.*

🔧 Science, Work & Industry ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Construction, Development, Innovation, Installations, Automation, Connectivity, Shipbuilding, Reindustrialised, Foundation, Infrastructure, Acquisition, Deploy, Recruitment, Transformation, Transformative, Framework, Semiconductor, Cybersecurity, Irrigation, Agricultural	noun/verb	creating, installing or expanding physical and industrial capacity.	*The (construction / development / innovation) drive rebuilt the region; new installations and automation improved connectivity, the yard resumed shipbuilding, and the area was reindustrialised on a firm foundation of infrastructure.*
Professional, Professionals, Occupation,	noun/adjective	jobs, the people who do them, and the	*The (professional / professionals) in each occupation trained*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Occupational, Apprenticeship, Apprenticeships, Manufacturers, Attendance, Reputation, Conventional, Individual, Adolescent, Responsibility, Responsible, Recognition		training that leads to them.	*through an (apprenticeship / apprenticeships); manufacturers reported strong attendance, and the occupational standard protected their reputation.*
Scientific, Computational, Algorithmic, Technological, Neuroscience, Anthropology, University, Mythological, Testosterone, Masculinity, Breastfeeding, Environmental, Environmentalist	adjective/noun	branches of study and the language of science and technology.	*The (scientific / computational / algorithmic / technological) work spanned neuroscience, anthropology and mythological studies at the university.*

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Sources: Curated word bank + mined editorial words, consolidated into meaning-families.